

Another Educational Institute Opens Its Gates to Open Source

Pune-headquartered Bharati Vidyapeeth has its institutions spread across India. In 2009, it adopted open source technology when it implemented the TechnoMail enterprise mailing solution to fulfil its communication needs.

With around 180 educational institutions under its umbrella, Bharati Vidyapeeth has become a leading national-level educational organisation. Today, it touches the lives of 2.5-lakh students, employs around 8,000 people and has used open source technology for smooth communication across the board to improve productivity. TechnoMail, the enterprise mailing solution by TechnoInfotech built on an enterprise Linux platform, was adopted in 2009 to provide a single communication platform that went a step ahead of just e-mail and catered to the organisation's active and passive communication.

How were the open source seeds sown?

Having grown by leaps and bounds in a short span of time, Bharati Vidyapeeth realised the need to streamline its de-centralised IT infrastructure and operations to sustain growth. "There was a need to study the latest trends

in technology and implement them to make administration and teaching more convenient and productive," says Satyajit Hange, director (technology), Bharati Vidyapeeth.

The first step towards that was creating a centralised IT department to evaluate, manage and standardise the IT infrastructure of close to 15,000 personal computers. The department was entrusted with the task of establishing a strong communication system that was scalable, accessible from any location, available 24x7, had a simple and comprehensive user interface and complete managed services. Thus, in 2009, the organisation adopted the open source TechnoMail solution.

Built on the CentOS distribution and with features like Qmail MTA, MailScanner, SpamAssassin, ClamAV anti-virus, Squirrel Mail, Group Office (a Web-based collaboration suite), MySQL, Joomla CMS, and a customised administration panel using a PHP and Ajax

